SMU

System Management Unit

Beta release | Open-source RTL | Apache 2.0

HIGHLIGHTS

- Coordinates OCAH clock/reset/power/thermal management, debug/test, and optional security subsystems
- Full reference configuration integrates SMC, SEP, DTP, and a 3-by-3 AXI4 fabric
- Alternate no-SEP configuration preserves SMC, DTP, and external AXI interfaces
- Runtime-programmed SMC/SEP address apertures with fixed, loop-free connectivity
- Integrated reset, clock-stop, lifecycle, mailbox, interrupt, and debug handoffs
- Technology-neutral core plus an open reference wrapper for macro substitution

SYSTEM ROLE

SMU is the composed management boundary between the chiplet system fabric, external debug and test equipment, adopter implementation resources, and the OCAH SMC, DTP, and optional SEP. It supplies their integration wiring and control handoffs; the adopter owns chiplet-level address assignment, non-vendor-neutral IPs, firmware policy, and product security authorization.

AT A GLANCE

Feature	Description
Main configuration	SMC + SEP + DTP
Alternate configuration	SMC + DTP
Full-config fabric	3 AXI4 inputs by 3 outputs; 2 runtime address rules
AXI4 boundary	56-bit address, 64-bit data, 12-bit user
AXI IDs	8-bit input; 10-bit crossbar output; 6-bit SMC/SEP target
External interrupts	256 to SMC; 212 to SEP when present
Mailbox instances	32 SMC; 8 SEP when present
External cross-trigger interfaces	16 CTPs; 8 internal trigger interfaces; 8 clock-stop request inputs

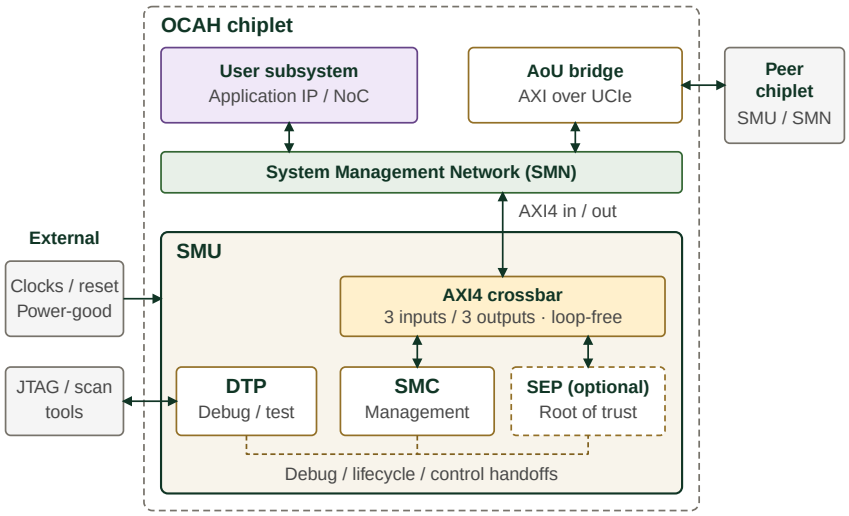
OVERVIEW

The System Management Unit (SMU) is a composite module providing a standardized OCAH compliant chiplet interface combining SEP, SMC, and DTP sub-blocks into a single instantiable subsystem with standardized interfaces to a user defined subsystem. The SMU provides chiplet functions such as clock, voltage and reset management in addition to Root of Trust (RoT) services in a physically isolated environment.

The composed subsystems include the debug and test ports (DTP), which provide standardized debug and test access across heterogeneous chiplets; the System Management Controller (SMC), responsible for clock, reset, voltage, and power management plus platform bootstrap and initialization; and the optional Security Processor (SEP), a physically isolated block providing Root of Trust (RoT) services.

SEP inclusion is selected independently for each SMU instance. A multi-chiplet system may contain SEP-equipped primary and secondary chiplets, together with secondary chiplets that omit SEP. The integrator defines the security hierarchy and the propagation of lifecycle and debug controls between chiplets.

SYSTEM CONTEXT



Without SEP: direct external AXI ¬ SMC paths
Adopter supplies technology macros, PHY, firmware and lifecycle policy

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CAPABILITIES

Composition and control

- SMC and DTP always instantiated; SEP selected at elaboration
- Internal wiring for DTP-to-SMC debug fabric and OTP, DTP-to-SEP debug and OTP, SEP-to-SMC mailbox/reset/security status, and SMC-to-DTP cross-trigger control
- SMC-owned primary reset sequencing, 32 subsystem reset/isolation slots, external boot/repair gate, watchdog handoffs, and DTP clock-stop output
- The SEP lifecycle controller enables or disables DTP debug and test paths

Full-configuration fabric

- Legal routes: SEP reaches SMC or the external output; SMC reaches SEP or the external output; the external input reaches SEP or SMC. Same-port loops and a direct external-input-to-external-output path are excluded (loop-free)
- Runtime SMC and SEP aperture base/size rules select the target for each access
- Unmatched SMC/SEP outbound traffic uses the external output; unmatched external inbound traffic receives a decode error
- AXI ID-width conversion at SMC/SEP targets; atomic operations disabled
- The checked-in RTL fixes a 1 GiB window that aliases SEP accesses to the SMC local address region

No-SEP behavior

- Direct external-to-SMC and SMC-to-external AXI paths retain the public widths
- DTP and its primary JTAG interface remain present with the debug-disable vector tied to all-enabled: STAPs, DFT/DFD scan access, and the SMC JTAG-to-AXI bridge are open, and no SMU input accepts lifecycle controls from another chiplet
- SEP memory, entropy, I/O, mailbox, lifecycle-error, and status ports are tied to defined inactive values; the SEP aperture reports zero size
- SEP OTP debug accesses receive DECERR and the SEP secondary TAP has no target

INTERFACES AND CONFIGURATION

Feature	Integration options
Clocks and resets	SMU, reference, peripheral, telemetry, SEP watchdog, and entropy-sample clocks; cold reset, power-good, boot/repair, DFT, and reset outputs
System fabric	Inbound and outbound 56-address/64-data AXI4; programmable SMC and SEP aperture status; adopter AXI/AXI4-Lite extensions
Debug and triggers	Primary JTAG, boundary/iJTAG/secondary scan chains, external reset-control slice, and current-reference counts of 16 CTPs, 8 local trigger paths, and 8 clock-stop requests
Management	256 SMC and 212 SEP external interrupts; 32 reset/isolation controls of chiplet resources; 32 SMC and 8 SEP mailbox interrupts; GPIO/UART events, telemetry, timer, straps, and RAS status. SEP resources apply only when SEP is present
Technology interfaces	SMC/SEP ROM and SRAM, eFuse/OTP, I3C table memory, trace memory, GPIO pads, PLL/PVT, entropy, and SEP crypto-memory boundaries
Build-time	SEP configuration, external entropy sources, JTAG functions/identity, and SEP memory/Adams Bridge options

INTEGRATION DEPENDENCIES

- Decide whether or not to include SEP.
- Assign non-overlapping chiplet envelopes and program non-overlapping SMC/SEP memory apertures. Change memory apertures only after outstanding transactions have completed.
- If SEP is not configured, feature-control bits are not forwarded over the die-to-die interface and access is open by default. Protect the chiplet by routing all debug and test access through, and gating it with, a primary chiplet's SEP-controlled DTP path; define this no-SEP security policy.
- Replace zero-valued JTAG identity and SEP security-token fields; supply reviewed firmware, provisioning, recovery, and update policy.
- Provide the non-vendor-neutral IPs and production integration: PLL/FLL clock control, reset/CDC constraints, power sequencing, pads, SRAM macros, OTP banks, PVT sensors, entropy, I/O, and physical implementation. Reference- wrapper models and error-slave terminations are examples only.
- Connect or terminate every external fabric, scan, trigger, interrupt, mailbox, reset/isolation, macro, and adopter-extension interface.

VERIFICATION AND MATURITY

The OCAH verification dashboard publishes the current verification and maturity status. Hosted cocotb/PyUVM smoke and regression exercise the no-SEP configuration, covering SMC/DTP composition, direct external AXI, filters, ID conversion, atomic rejection, JTAG-to-AXI/OTP, reset, mailbox, cross-trigger, and clock-stop scenarios. The SEP-present configuration is also verified, spanning no-SEP and real-SEP profiles including firmware and SEP boot-readiness observations.

There is no agreed functional-coverage closure target or SMU RTL code-coverage configuration. No standards certification, silicon characterization, product security assessment, or portable frequency, area, power, latency, or throughput result is claimed.

DELIVERABLES

- SMU RTL assets, packages, and dependency filelists
- Reference integration wrapper and open IP-integration examples
- SystemRDL/generated registers and interface documentation
- Integrator guidance, specification, and synthesis constraints
- cocotb/PyUVM core and wrapper environments, firmware, and verification plans
- Apache License 2.0 repository distribution

RESOURCES

Documentation: docs.tenstorrent.com/tt-oca-harness
SMU documentation: Technical Reference Manual
Core and reference wrapper RTL: `hw/sys/smu/rtl/`, `hw/top/`
Verification: `hw/sys/smu/dv/`
Integrator Guide: `doc/integrator/`
Project: github.com/tenstorrent/tt-oca-harness

TERMS

RoT: root of trust. CTP: cross trigger port. DECERR: decode error. OTP: one-time programmable. RAS: reliability, availability, and serviceability.

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Version	Date	Author	Change

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